



OJAI VALLEY SANITARY DISTRICT

A Public Agency

1072 Tico Road, Ojai, California 93023

(805) 646-5548 • FAX (805) 640-0842

E-mail: www.ojaisan.org

January 24, 2023

Renee Purdy, Executive Officer
California Regional Water Quality Control Board
Los Angeles Region
320 W. 4th Street, Suite 200
Los Angeles, CA 90013

Attn: Tsai Don

NON-COMPLIANCE – EFFLUENT DISINFECTION & TURBIDITY REQUIREMENT NPDES NO. CA-0053961, CI NO. 4245

This is Ojai Valley Sanitary District's (OVSD) follow-up letter to my e-mail notifications 1-11 & 1-16-23 to Tsai Don regarding treatment plant effluent violations as listed:

EFFLUENT DISINFECTION EXCEEDANCE

- 1-10-23 The requirement "the number of total coliform bacteria does not exceed 23 MPN or CFU per 100 milliliters in more than one sample within any 30-day period" was exceeded with a result of 46 MPN which followed a result of 130 NTU on 1-9-23.

EFFLUENT TURBIDITY EXCEEDANCE

- 1-9-23 The requirement "does not exceed a daily average of 2 Nephelometric turbidity units (NTU)" was exceeded with a result of 3.67 NTU.
- 1-9-23 The requirement "does not exceed 5 NTU more than 5% of the time (72 minutes) during any 24 hour period" was exceeded and above 5 NTU more than 5% of the time.
- 1-9-23 The requirement "does not exceed 10 NTU at any time" was exceeded 1-9-23 into 1-10-23 continuously for a total of 5 hours and 58 minutes.
- 1-10-23 The requirement "does not exceed a daily average of 2 Nephelometric turbidity units (NTU)" was exceeded with a result of 3.0 NTU.
- 1-10-23 The requirement "does not exceed 5 NTU more than 5% of the time (72 minutes) during any 24 hour period" was exceeded and above 5 NTU more than 5% of the time.

Storm events in the District's service area 1-9 and 1-10-23 followed several smaller storms and produced heavy rainfall with well above normal rainfall intensities and cumulative totals. The rainfall totals produced flow rates in the Ventura River and San Antonio Creek that exceeded flood stages. Forecasters predicted 3-6 inches in the Ventura County mountains. In fact, Nordhoff Ridge in the Ojai Valley watershed totaled nearly

14 inches during the rain event. The heavy rainfall and total ground saturation resulted in significant increases in flow rates to the plant and the need to increase flow rates through the treatment plant. The plant was taxed very hard hydraulically and saw a long period of plant influent flows of 10-12 MGD (3-4 times normal peak flows). High plant process velocities carry more solids due to the reduction in process detention time, increases plant effluent turbidity, and reduces the effectiveness of disinfection. During the extremely high flow periods, all efforts were made to divert as much secondary effluent to water retention areas to minimize impacts to the plant.

Plant flows are still elevated following the storm events however the plant has stabilized and is back in compliance.

If you have any questions or comments regarding the above information, please contact me at (805) 646-5548.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, consisting of a large, stylized 'B' followed by a series of loops and a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Bradshaw Pruitt
Treatment Plant Supervisor/ CPO